could be used in the future. Though there were no papers and documents to throw light on Ahuja's background, the Europe desk's reports on Sethi and Sandhu had described the man as intelligent, well-mannered and never afraid to speak his mind.

Sophie had arranged the meeting at Cafe Munding in the old town. Ahuja was polite but distant. Jindal was curious to know why he had left a comfortable life in California and ended up in Austria, struggling for money. Ahuja frankly told him that he had enjoyed his life in California but disliked the gatherings at Sethi's house, which he thought to be anti-national. 'Sethi has sold his soul. He is a traitor and working hand in glove with Sandhu to harm India. I couldn't bear the thought of betrayal/ he said.

Jindal was convinced that the intelligence reports about Ahuja and Sethi were correct. When they began a discussion about antiIndia activities from the USA and Europe, Jindal told Ahuja that he worked for the R&AW and his business was merely a front.

'Our job is to secure the nation and insulate it from the influence of enemies/ Jindal stressed. Ahuja was surprised. He fumbled for words and looked at Sophie. She assured him he was in safe hands.

Jindal recruited Ahuja in Austria that April. Upon agreeing to work for the R&AW as a spy, Ahuja was given the codename Einsiedler. He agreed to revive contact with Sethi but asked Jindal for money to send back to his family in India. Jindal decided that Sophie would be his handler to avoid any suspicion, but there would be minimum personal contact. Any intelligence Ahuja harvested would be transmitted through dead drops. In the espionage lexicon, a dead drop is a